

and warehousing. “Flipkart has the financial muscle. While grocery does not demand heavy cash burn or deep discounting, the capital needed for geographic and category expansion wouldn’t be a constraint for large firms like Flipkart,” says Rathi.

However, with Amazon ramping up its quick commerce play with Tez, the competition is set to intensify. Another hurdle for Flipkart Minutes could be its leadership. Reports suggest that Kabeer Biswas, co-founder and CEO of Dunzo, was set to take charge of the business. However, with Dunzo facing financial distress and being dragged to the National Company Law Tribunal over unpaid dues, Biswas’s potential involvement remains unclear.

The vertical is currently being overseen by Hemant Badri, Group SVP & Head of Supply Chain, Customer Experience, and ReCommerce Business; the company is

yet to announce a dedicated head of the vertical. “Talent is abundant at Flipkart. Ultimately, it all comes down to how nimble Flipkart can be.” Queries to Flipkart and Kabeer Biswas remained unanswered.

Meanwhile, competition is intensifying. Blinkit and Swiggy Instamart continue to burn cash. Swiggy’s Q3 FY25 results indicate that Instamart’s contribution margin dipped to -4.6% from -1.9% in the previous quarter. The adjusted EBITDA was

- ₹490 cr. Blinkit saw over 15% QoQ decline in adjusted EBITDA at ₹103 crore due to rapid expansion of its dark store network.

Yet, consolidation may not be far off. An investor draws parallels with the early days of e-commerce in India. “Back in 2013, many start-ups entered the e-commerce space, but only a handful survived. We now see only three-four prominent players. Quick commerce will likely follow a similar trajectory,” he says.

For Flipkart Minutes, the road ahead is both promising and challenging. While its capital muscle and established supply chain offer an advantage, the perception of the brand, absence of a clear leadership structure and aggressive expansion by rivals mean the coming months will be crucial to its success in India’s quick commerce battlefield. **BT**

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